Tones of Note

Music proposal | Daisy and Andrew – 19 – 21 November 2020

Your wedding is an intimate reflection of you and as such requires musical and creative attention. To authentically convey that feeling to the guests sharing in this momentous day, your musical input is invaluable.

Over the next months, we'll be working with you on your wedding soundtrack. Building on our experience of what works and what doesn't, we'll guide you in the repertoire selection process from guest arrivals to closing song.

Most of the suggested acts below are open to learning new repertoire, so if you've got something specific in mind, let us know. While we'll try to our best to accommodate you, we'll also be honest when we feel something won't work musically or is not possible.

Welcome event – Thursday, 19 November 2020

Guests arrive to the authentic and lively sound of Cape Town based Marimba band Il Afro Suns, who play a combination of traditional African repertoire and reinterpreted popular songs. The celebratory tone of the music is a perfect way to welcome your guests. With the focus primarily on the Marimbas rather than drummers, the overall intensity and volume will be such that guests can speak and socialize comfortably.

Once the bulk of guests have arrived, they will be encouraged to make their way to the reception area. Facilitating this transition, the drummers from the marimba band can lead the guests to the reception area, opening the DJ's set. The DJ continues for the remainder of the event with the option of saxophone on selected tracks.

Instagram - Il Afro Suns
Instagram - Il Afro Suns 2

Wedding – Friday, 20 November 2020

Ceremony:

As guests arrive and take their seats for the ceremony, they'll be welcomed by 9-piece vocal ensemble *Asili*, whose repertoire includes traditional African, hymns as well as contemporary pieces. The addition of piano accompaniment opens the repertoire up to instrumental pieces and there is also the option of playing songs through the PA. Marking this joyous occasion, Asili to end the ceremony with an impactful song, leading guests to the pre-drinks area.

Instagram - Asili Vocal Ensemble
Expresso Show - Something Inside So Strong

Pre-drinks:

Building on the emotion created at the ceremony, this period allows guests to catch up with friends and family while taking in their surroundings. The music during this time should animate/enliven those conversations not interfere or compete with them. Keeping that in mind, here are two options:

Option One: Ethan Florus

Reinterpreting and performing a wide range of songs from Drake's *Hot Line Bling* to Alicia Key's *If I Ain't Got You*, Ethan Florus brings warmth and soul to his performances in a refreshing way. Ethan performs in a few musical configurations but given the number guests and function, we'd recommend a trio or quartet for this set.

Ethan Florus - Unaware [Allen Stone cover]

Option Two: DJ

A DJ is a good alternative to a live performer for pre-drinks, with the music during this period setting the tone for the rest of the night. Musically speaking, DJs have a broader range of styles and songs to choose from, allowing them to take the music where the guests want it to go. Ultimately this set must be upbeat, featuring songs that appeal to the majority of your guests while also representing your musical preferences.

This is achieved by playing a mix of classics from soul, jazz, reggae and current popular music. To find out which songs from those genres most resonate, we've included a 90-minute sampler below. Please give it a listen and send us your feedback. We'll use that to curate the set.

Rus Nerwich - Pre-drinks sampler

Dinner:

Option One: Jazz quartet

While guests enjoy dinner, we suggest a jazz quartet including saxophone, double bass, piano and drums. The interplay between the different instrumentalists provides variety for guests whether they are actively listening or not. Providing a sophisticated soundtrack for uninterrupted conversation, this set is mostly comprised of instrumental songs with the inclusion of a male or female vocalists on featured songs to build the tempo as we near the first dance and party to follow.

For videos of the quartet's past performances, please see the following links:

Rus Nerwich Quartet - Swing Dinner Set

Rus Nerwich Quartet - St. Thomas

Francesca Biancoli - Bossa Nova Set

Dinner:

Option Two: DJ

Rus Nerwich to DJ during curated dinner music, facilitating flow around speeches.

Dance: Starlight Band

Vocalists Nathan Ambach and Francesca Biancoli lead this 8-piece band including keys, bass, guitar saxophone, trumpet and drums to perform high-energy dance set opening the dancefloor.

Tones of Note

Touring and performing together for the last 6 years, Rus Nerwich and Nathan Ambach (N8N) have developed an electric onstage chemistry, offering clients an all-inclusive musical solution.

Both Nathan and Rus bring together 20 years of musical and performance experience. From world-class live performances of quintessential classics covering soul, funk, blues, pop and jazz to a dance till you can't dance no more DJ set, you are guaranteed one of the greatest parties of your life!
For videos of the band's past performances, please see the following links:

Instagram - Starlight Band - Rus and Nate

Instagram - Starlight Band - Rus and Nate (1)

Starlight Band - Happy

Francesca Biancoli - Volare

For more videos, please check out the website - Starlight Band.

Party set: Option One - DJ Nathan Ambach

Nathan launched the nightlife series: The Love Below as 'Your Monthly Rendezvous with Soul' in 2006 in his hometown of Antwerp, where he is still the resident DJ + promoter of funky music worldwide!

He's DJ'd alongside Mark Ronson at the WMC in Miami and played at the Love Below with DJ Jazzy Jeff (The Fresh Prince), DJ Premier, DJ Maseo (De La Soul), and DJ Rashida – the official tour DJ of Prince and Bruno Mars and DJ'd sets in clubs and events around Europe, America, Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

His Spotify playlists and online mixtapes represent his funky style, championing soulful music with great grooves and party hooks. For over 20 years, N8N has been rocking the business from BBQs to Bar-Mitzvahs!

N8N - The DJ Side of the Story

Party set: Option Two - DJ Colin Sher

After qualifying in sound engineering, Colin has worked with Rude World Records and independenlty as a producer, songwriter and DJ. He has remixes and features with artists such as Jimmy Nevis, Danny K, Mark Haze and Chad Saaiman.

An experienced and versatile DJ, Colin has performed at many of Cape Town's top clubs and parties. Some notable highlights include being the official DJ for the Coca-Cola pre-game events in Cape Town during the 2010 Soccer World Cup and performing at Trinity for the official U2, Coldplay and Kings of Leon afterparties. He's also been a resident and guest DJ at many clubs in Cape Town over the years, such as St Yves, Tiger Tiger, Trinity, La Roi, Affinity, 91, The Grand and many more.

DJ Colin Sher - Promo video

DJ Colin Sher ft. Jimmy Nevis